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AFP

SUNITA WILLIAMS BACK AFTER MARATHON SPACE ODYSSEY

Nasa astronaut Sunita Williams being helped out of a SpaceX Dragon spacecraft on board the SpaceX recovery ship MEGAN off the coast of Tallahassee, Florida, yesterday. After a lengthy journey that turned a planned eight-day mission into nine months in space, Williams and Butch Wilmore, along with Nasa's Nick Hague and Russian cosmonaut Aleksandr Gorbunov, safely splashed down off the coast of Florida at 1:57am UAE time.

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Israel launches targeted ground operations in Gaza

DEFENCE MINISTER ISSUES 'LAST WARNING' TO RELEASE HOSTAGES

JERUSALEM

Israel's military said that it had launched "targeted ground operations" in Gaza after conducting a series of air strikes on a scale not seen since a cease-fire began in January.

"Over the past 24 hours, IDF (military) forces have begun targeted ground operations in the central and southern Gaza Strip to expand the security perimeter and create a partial buffer between the north and south of the Strip," the army said in a statement, adding that troops had "taken control and expanded their presence up to the central Netzarim Corridor".

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz issued a "last warning" to Gazans yesterday, saying in a video statement that they should follow the advice of US President Donald Trump and return Israeli hostages and remove Hamas from power.

"Residents of Gaza, this is

the last warning," Katz said. "Take the advice of the President of the United States. Return the hostages and remove Hamas, and other options will open up for you — including the possibility of leaving for other places in the world for those who want to."

Open to negotiations

Meanwhile, Hamas said it remained open to negotiations while calling for pressure on Israel to implement a Gaza truce.

French President Emmanuel Macron said yesterday, alongside Jordan's King Abdullah II, that Israel's resumption of strikes on the Gaza Strip "represents a major step in the wrong direction".

EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas said she asked Israel's foreign minister Gideon Saar, "Why are you doing this?" during a conversation Tuesday.

— AFP

SEE ALSO P10

FEED HOPE

Gulf News has partnered with the UAE Food Bank to launch the 'Feed Hope This Ramadan' campaign, inviting residents to donate generously to ensure that food reaches those who need it most. Every Dh100 donated will provide essential groceries for 80 meals during this fasting month.

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IFTAR 18:33

Fajr	05:06	Shuruq	06:19
Dhuhr	12:29	Asr	15:54
Maghrib	18:33	Isha	19:47

IMSAK 04:56

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

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